

Learning Intention: I can plan and create an imaginative text using strong characters, settings and events.

Success Criteria — I can:

- Plan a character, setting and event for my story.
- Use descriptive language to bring my writing to life.
- Edit my writing to improve it.

Writing Strategy — The Story Mountain

Every imaginative story needs: **1) Character & Setting** (who and where) → **2) Problem/Event** (something happens) → **3) Resolution** (how it's solved or ends). Planning these first makes writing much easier.

Model — A Story Plan

Story part	Example plan
Character	Ari, a curious 9-year-old who loves maps
Setting	An overgrown garden behind Ari's new house
Problem/Event	Ari finds an old, rusted gate hidden in the ivy, half-open
Resolution	Ari decides to explore, discovering a forgotten garden with a story of its own

Mini Model — Opening Paragraph

Ari had always loved maps, but no map had ever shown her **this**. Behind the tangled curtain of ivy at the back of the new house stood a gate — rusted, half-open, and completely unexpected. Her heart thudded with a mix of nerves and excitement as she reached out and pushed it wider.

Notice: descriptive words ("tangled", "rusted"), a feeling ("nerves and excitement"), and a hint of what's to come.

Parent Tip

Before your child starts writing, ask them to describe their character, setting and problem out loud first — talking through a story idea often makes writing it down much easier.

Key Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Imaginative text	A story created from imagination, not real events
Setting	Where and when a story takes place
Edit	To check and improve a piece of writing

Try It

Say your character, setting and problem out loud to a partner or family member before you start planning on Page 2.

Plan & Draft Your Story

Q1 – Plan Your Story

Story part	My plan
Character	
Setting	
Problem/Event	
Resolution	

Q2 — Add Descriptive Detail

Rewrite each plain sentence, adding descriptive detail (adjectives, feelings, or sensory detail).

a) Plain: The dog ran into the yard.

Improved: _____

b) Plain: She opened the door.

Improved: _____

Q3 – Word Bank for Description

Circle 3 words below you could use in your story.

mysterious · ancient · gleaming · trembling · enormous · hushed · glimmering · tangled · forgotten · sudden

Q4 – Write Your Opening Paragraph

Using your plan from Q1, write the opening paragraph of your story. Introduce your character and setting, and hint at the problem.

Continue, Edit & Reflect

Continue Your Story

Continue your story from Page 2. Include your event/problem and how it ends (your resolution).

Edit Your Writing

Read your story again and check:

- ☐ Capital letters at the start of sentences and for names.
- ☐ Full stops (or other end punctuation) at the end of sentences.
- ☐ At least 3 descriptive words used.
- ☐ The story makes sense from beginning to end.

Reflect

One thing I'm proud of in my story: _____

One thing I could improve next time: _____

Teacher Support

Marking Guide

This is a creative task with no single correct answer. Look for:

- ☐ A clear character, setting and event, matching the student's own plan.
- ☐ Descriptive language used purposefully (not just added words).
- ☐ A logical story structure with a resolution.
- ☐ Evidence of independent editing (corrections visible or a completed checklist).

Teacher Tip

Encourage students to read their story aloud to a partner before final editing — hearing it often reveals missing words or confusing sentences more clearly than silent reading. This worksheet completes the Literature strand alongside AC9E3LE01, LE02 and LE04.